discriminatory social and religious customs. He was a fiery and provocative social reformer who attacked not only caste but also wealth and gender inequality.

Forging a new identity

Annadurai met Periyar in 1935 at a public political event; it was the beginning of a fruitful intellectual partnership. Dissatisfied with the Justice Party's narrow focus, the two men worked to transform it into a movement that would promote wider cultural and social change. They renamed the party Dravidar Kazhagam (DK). Alongside advocating women's rights and the abolition of caste, they popularized the idea that south Indian non-Brahmins have their own distinct Dravidian ethnic identity. The DK focused on educating Dravidians (Tamils and other southern communities) about their rich history, language and culture, and demanded the rejection of Aryan (north Indian) cultural practices.

One of the demands of the Dravidian movement was the creation of a separate nation called Dravida Nadu. The demand persisted well into the 1950s.

